

Afifah Kashif

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Research interests: AI evaluation [2,3,5,9], human-AI and human-robot interaction [1,4,6,8], and AI governance [3,6–8]

EDUCATION

University of Cambridge

Cambridge, UK

M.Phil. Human-Inspired Artificial Intelligence (with Distinction)

Oct 2025 – Jun 2026

Dissertation: Bias by Whose Definition? The Construct Validity of Dictionary-Based and LLM-as-Judge Bias

Evaluation in Conversational AI (Supervisors: Dr. Jin Huang, Dr. Malak Sadek, Dr. Hatice Gunes)

University of Washington, Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering

Seattle, USA

B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Law, Societies & Justice

Sep 2022 – Jun 2025

Study Abroad: Rome, Italy (Jan – Mar 2024), Honors: *The Global Refugee Crisis: From Devastation to Diaspora*

GPA: 3.77/4.00, Dean's List, Completed one year early

Capstone: Ointment Care Robot for Limited Mobility Users (Instructor: Dr. Maya Cakmak)

Bellevue College

Bellevue, USA

A.A. Arts and Sciences; A.S. Engineering, Physics and Atmospheric Sciences

Sep 2020 – Jun 2022

Earned concurrently with high school through dual credit; GPA: 3.98/4.00, Dean's List

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Visiting Researcher, Stanford University

Sep 2026 – Present

Prof. Julian Nyarko, Dr. Megan Ma (Legal Innovation through Frontier Technology (Lift)Lab, Stanford Law School)

Research Assistant, University of Cambridge

Jul 2026 – Present

Dr. Katie Seaborn (Aspirational Computing Lab, Department of Computer Science and Technology), Dr. Malak Sadek

(Human Interactions, Values & Experiences with Conversational AI (HIVE) Lab, Centre for Human Inspired AI)

Researcher, PluralisticAI Lab

Mar 2026 – Present

Dr. Zhenzhen Qi (University of Connecticut), Dr. Avijit Ghosh (Hugging Face)

CORDA Democracy Fellow, Odyssean Institute

Apr 2026 – Sep 2026

Jacob Haimes (Apart Research), Dr. Swaptik Chowdhury (RAND)

Research Assistant, University of Washington

Sep 2024 – Jun 2025

Dr. Amy Ko (Wordplay Project, UW Information School)

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Robotics Software Engineering Intern, Hello Robot

May 2025 – Aug 2025

Human-Robot Interaction and UX focus (Dr. Vinitha Ranganeni)

Backend Software Engineering Intern, HowellCo

Jul 2024 – Sep 2024

Software Engineering Intern, Code.org

Jul 2023 – Sep 2023

Operations and Product Intern, Fiveable

Apr 2021 – Nov 2021

PUBLICATIONS

[1] Designing Power Systems as a Social Interface for Assistive Robots

Afifah Kashif, Vy Nguyen, Vinitha Ranganeni

ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) 2027. [Under Review]

[2] Do Language and Visual Perturbations Compound? Interaction Effects and Backend Sensitivity in Compact Vision-Language-Action Model Evaluation

Abdul Muhsin Hameed, Afifah Kashif, Asim Iqbal

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2027. [Under Review]

[3] Synthetic Dataset Creation as Governance Infrastructure for Embodied AI Bias Evaluation

Afifah Kashif

UK AI Research Symposium (UKAIRS) 2026, Emerging Research Track.

[4] Beyond the Monolithic Interface: A Research Agenda for Plural Conversational AI

Avijit Ghosh, Afifah Kashif, Isabelle Kohout, Zhenzhen Qi

Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (Nature Portfolio). [Under Review]

[5] Mapping Collective Imaginaries of AI Risk: Expert Elicitation, Causal Modeling and LLM-Assisted Coding

Anshikha Kumar*, Afifah Kashif*, Jacob Haimés, Swaptik Chowdhury

AI4GOOD Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026.

*Equal contribution

[6] Governance as Methodology: Toward Anticipatory, Design-Embedded Governance for Human-Robot Interaction

Afifah Kashif, Malak Sadek

2nd Interactive AI for Human-Centered Robotics Workshop @ ACM/IEEE HRI 2026.

[7] Governance at the Edge of Architecture: Regulating NeuroAI and Neuromorphic Systems

Afifah Kashif, Abdul Hameed, Asim Iqbal

arXiv:2602.01503, 2026. [Preprint]

[8] Regulatory Considerations for Physically Assistive Robotics Researchers

Afifah Kashif, Amal Nanavati, Maya Cakmak

Physical Caregiving Robots Workshop @ ACM/IEEE HRI 2025.

[9] Assessing GPT's Bias Towards Stigmatized Social Groups: An Intersectional Case Study on Nationality Prejudice and Psychophobia

Afifah Kashif*, Heer Patel*

*Equal contribution

Considering Cultural and Linguistic Diversity in AI Workshop @ ASIS&T US West 2025

Other Writing

The Hidden Social Costs of AI

EvalEval Coalition. Blog Post. November 2025.

HONORS AND AWARDS

Winner, Hack the Law Research Pitch (2026): Stanford x Cambridge competition for funded research placement.

Top 5 Nominee, Academic Representative of the Year (2026): Cambridge Excellence Awards.

Marcy Migdal Fellowship (2025): UW Center for Global Studies; funded a digital literacy program for recently resettled refugee women.

Nordic Scholars Leadership Institute (2025): Inaugural cohort, Stockholm, Sweden.

Distinguished Leader Award (2023): Harvard WECODE.

TALKS

Panelist, "Intergenerational Perspectives on AI in a Changing World"

Jun 2026

Centre for Human-Inspired AI, Annual Conference, University of Cambridge Union

Dissertation Seminar, "Bias by Whose Definition?"

May 2026

Centre for Human-Inspired AI, University of Cambridge

Speaker, CHIA Early Career Community Event

May 2026

Centre for Human-Inspired AI, University of Cambridge

Guest Lecture, "An Ethical AI Lens for Neuroinclusive Design"

Feb 2026

Inclusive Design Futures (Dr. Matteo Zallio), University of Cambridge

Speaker, "The Politics of Educational Technology"

Feb 2026

Clareity × Whiston Series, Clare College 700th Anniversary, University of Cambridge

SERVICE

Program Committee: UserSim: Grounded User Simulation Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026

Workshop Host: CMD-IT/ACM Richard Tapia Conference 2024 (first and only undergraduate team)

Hackathon Organizer: Shared Futures Foundation London Ethics Buildathon, 2026; Techtogether Seattle, 2023

Member: EvalEval Coalition

2025 – Present

AI Research Events Lead: Cambridge AI Research Society

2026 – 2026

Last updated September 2026

Academic Representative: Cambridge Institute of Technology and Humanity	2025 – 2026
Executive Officer: Paul G. Allen School Student Advisory Council, University of Washington	2022 – 2024
Co-Founder and Vice President: Women in Law Society, University of Washington	2023 – 2025

TEACHING

Supervisor, Computer Science and Human-Computer Interaction <i>University of Cambridge</i>	Oct 2025 – Mar 2026 <i>Cambridge, UK</i>
Founder and Instructor, Digital Literacy Program <i>International Rescue Committee and Kabul Seattle Community Services</i>	Jan 2025 – Present <i>Seattle, WA</i>
Teaching Assistant, Intro Programming and The Hardware/Software Interface <i>University of Washington</i>	Jan 2023 – Mar 2025 <i>Seattle, WA</i>
Section Leader, Code in Place <i>Stanford University</i>	Apr 2024 – May 2024 <i>Remote</i>
Language and Literacy Teacher <i>CPIAI Roma</i>	Jan 2024 – Mar 2024 <i>Rome, Italy</i>

LANGUAGES

English (native), Urdu/Hindi (native)